

/research

Research system: /research create [--mode tiered|supervisor|competitive] ... | list | open | search | show | delete | archive | cluster

Overview

/research drives the structured research pipeline: web search plus local file cross-referencing, synthesis, and a self-contained RESEARCH.md output. Projects are named, persisted, and can be listed, resumed, clustered, exported, and imported. Create accepts a rich flag set covering depth, tier, mode, per-stage models, concurrency, timeouts, and source limits. The TUI runs the pipeline on a background task while the status bar shows [wait] research: <name>....

Syntax

```
/research help
/research create <name> <topic> [flags]
/research list [--all] [--json]
/research show <name> [--json]
/research open <name>
/research search <query> [--json]
/research delete <name> [--yes]
/research archive <name>
/research resume <name>
/research continue <name> [--message <text>]
/research update <name>
/research cluster <name> [--force]
/research export <name> [--output <path>]
/research import <path> [--name <name>]
/research config
```

The first positional after create is the project name; everything after it is the topic. The parser splits on whitespace and honours double quotes, so a topic can be quoted as one argument.

Subcommands

Form	Description
create <name> <topic>	Starts a research project. See the flag table below.
list [--all] [--json]	Lists projects; --all includes archived, --json emits JSON.
show <name> [--json]	Shows project state and findings; --json emits JSON.
open <name>	Opens the project's RESEARCH.md in the log panel.
search <query> [--json]	Searches stored research content.
delete <name> [--yes]	Deletes a project; --yes skips confirmation.
archive <name>	Moves a project to the archive.
resume <name>	Resumes an interrupted or archived project.

Form	Description
<code>continue <name> [--message <text>]</code>	Continues an existing project with an optional steering message.
<code>update <name></code>	Refreshes an existing project's findings.
<code>cluster <name> [--force]</code>	Runs research clustering on the project; <code>--force</code> re-runs over existing clusters.
<code>export <name> [--output <path>]</code>	Exports the project bundle to a path.
<code>import <path> [--name <name>]</code>	Imports a project bundle, optionally renaming it.
<code>config</code>	Shows the resolved research configuration.
<code>help</code>	Prints the subcommand table.

Create flags

Flag	Values / Default
<code>--from-url, --from-url (repeatable)</code>	Seed the run from one or more URLs.
<code>--from-file, --from-file (repeatable)</code>	Seed the run from local files.
<code>--iterations N</code>	Iteration budget for the gather loop.
<code>--depth</code>	<code>shallow</code> <code>standard</code> <code>deep</code> .
<code>--tier</code>	<code>light</code> <code>full</code> <code>dissertation</code> .
<code>--mode</code>	<code>tiered</code> <code>supervisor</code> <code>competitive</code> . <code>competitive</code> implies <code>--format comparison-table</code> .
<code>--summarization-model</code>	<code><provider:model></code> override for summarisation.
<code>--research-model</code>	<code><provider:model></code> override for the researcher stage.
<code>--compression-model</code>	<code><provider:model></code> override for compression.
<code>--final-report-model</code>	<code><provider:model></code> override for the final report.
<code>--max-concurrent-research-units N</code>	Parallel research unit cap.
<code>--format</code>	<code>report</code> <code>executive-summary</code> <code>comparison-table</code> <code>source-bibliography</code> <code>imrad</code> .
<code>--sources-dir <dir></code>	Local sources directory to cross-reference.
<code>--template <name></code>	Output template override.
<code>--fetch-concurrently N</code>	Concurrent fetch cap (default 10).
<code>--local-concurrently N</code>	Concurrent local-file reads (default 8).
<code>--fetch-timeout-secs N</code>	Per-fetch timeout (default 30).
<code>--web-phase-timeout-secs / --web-time N</code>	Web phase budget.
<code>--local-phase-timeout-secs N</code>	Local phase budget.
<code>--search-max-retries N</code>	Search retry count (default 2).
<code>--search-retry-base-delay-ms N</code>	Retry backoff base (default 200).
<code>--max-web-results N</code>	Web result cap.
<code>--max-search-calls N</code>	Search-call cap.
<code>--max-local-sources N</code>	Local source cap.
<code>--max-synthesis-sources N</code>	Sources admitted into synthesis.
<code>--max-concepts N</code>	Output cap on the <code>## Concepts</code> list (default 5; 0 = unbounded). Per-run override of <code>research.max_concepts</code> .

Flag	Values / Default
<code>--max-findings N</code>	Output cap on the <code>## Findings</code> list (default 20; 0 = unbounded). Per-run override of <code>research.max_findings</code> .
<code>--brief <text></code>	Provide the brief up front, skipping clarification.
<code>--use-local</code>	Include local file sources.
<code>--use-specs</code>	Include spec documents as sources.
<code>--use-low-relevance</code>	Keep low-relevance hits.
<code>--no-papers</code>	Exclude scholarly-paper engines (OpenAlex) before any search request. Alias: <code>--no-scholarly</code> .
<code>--use-pdf</code>	Enable PDF extraction.
<code>--clarify / --no-clarify</code>	Force on or off the clarification stage. Off by default.
<code>--evaluate</code>	Enable evaluation scoring of findings.
<code>--url-cloak</code>	Emit web source URLs as defanged plain text (<code>hxxps://host[.]tld/...</code> in a code span) in the <code>Sources</code> bullets and <code>References</code> Index table. Off by default.

Examples

```
/research create rust-async "Compare tokio and async-std task scheduling models"
```

Names the project `rust-async`, uses everything after it as the topic.

```
/research create deep-dive "tree-sitter incremental parsing" --tier dissertation --depth deep
```

Runs a deep, dissertation-tier project.

```
/research create db-compare "sqlite vs duckdb analytics" --mode competitive
```

Competitive mode forces `--format comparison-table` output.

```
/research create local-audit "unsafe usage" --sources-dir ./crates --use-local --use-specs
```

Cross-references local crates and spec documents.

```
/research create fast "tokio broadcast channels" --tier light --fetch-concurrently 20 --web-phase
```

A light run with a raised fetch concurrency and web budget.

```
/research create brief "vector databases" --max-concepts 3 --max-findings 10
```

Caps the report to 3 concepts and 10 findings (most-relevant-first).

```
/research create exhaustive "multi-agent orchestration" --max-concepts 0 --max-findings 0
```

Disables both output caps (0 means unbounded).

```
/research create vendors "managed vector database vendors" --url-cloak
```

Defangs web URLs in the report so automated scanners do not treat them as clickable links.

```
/research create rerun "existing project" --summarization-model ollama:qwen2.5:1.5b
```

Routes the summarisation stage to a fast local model.

```
/research list --all
```

Lists every project including archived ones.

```
/research continue rust-async --message "Focus on the cancellation paths"
```

Continues a project with steering guidance.

Output

- While running, the status bar shows `[wait] research: <name>...` and the pipeline streams progress lines into the message window.
- On completion the project's `RESEARCH.md` is written and a summary block lists the report path, source counts, and synthesis highlights.
- `list` renders a project table; `--json` variants emit machine-readable output for scripting.
- Failures print the failing stage with a corrective message; the project remains resumable via `/research resume`.

Related

- `ragent research` CLI runs the same engine outside the TUI.
- `GET/POST/DELETE /research` HTTP endpoints mirror these operations.
- `/research cluster` relies on the research clustering engine.
- See `docs/research-phase2-plan.md` and the research system docs for internals.